

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

A cleaning service makes housework simple!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How usual is it for people in your country to have help cleaning their homes?
- Is this done by a professional service, or by finding a person to come and do it?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about domestic activities.
- I can use proper intonation in short questions and statements.
- I can stress *I* and *you*.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa's mom is a bit of a **neat freak***!

* "A *neat freak*" likes everything tidy all of the time.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Hey Vanessa! What happened to you? You look so down today.
- Vanessa:** Yeah, I am pretty stressed out. My parents are coming to visit. Because my work schedule is so busy, I haven't had the chance to clean. My mom is a bit of a neat freak. She'll be very disappointed in me. You understand why I'm upset, don't you?
- Sally:** Hmmm.
- Vanessa:** The windows and floor need to be washed. The carpets need vacuuming. The kitchen and bathroom need a good scrub! The garbage needs to be taken out ...
- Sally:** Don't worry. We can get your place cleaned up. They're coming next week, aren't they?
- Vanessa:** No, they aren't. They are coming in two days! I'm working long shifts today and tomorrow. I'll have no time to clean! This is a big problem, isn't it?
- Sally:** No, it's not. I am sure we can find a solution. You've tried calling the cleaning companies already, haven't you?
- Vanessa:** No, I haven't. We don't have cleaning companies here in Cambridge, do we?
- Sally:** Yes, we do. I call them all the time. You can too! I can call today if you can't. I'm not working today like you are.
- Vanessa:** Thanks Sally, you're phenomenal!
- Sally:** They have great rates. I can make sure everything is washed, tidied, dusted, and put away while you work. You stop worrying. I'll take care of it. I'm a great organizer!
- Vanessa:** You are the best, Sally! I'll leave it to you!
- Sally:** I get to help you out for a change!



Let's Practice!

I didn't do it. Did you?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the stressed words in the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I call them all the time.
2. I can call today if you can't.
3. I'm not working today like you are.
4. Thanks Sally, you're phenomenal!
5. I can make sure everything is washed while you work.
6. I'm a great organizer!
7. You are the best, Sally!
8. I get to help you out for a change!



Let's Practice!

Let's clean up the house!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select all the sentences which talk about domestic activities.

1. ___ The windows and floor need to be washed.
2. ___ There is a lot of garbage in here.
3. ___ The carpets need a vacuuming.
4. ___ The kitchen and bathroom need a good scrub.
5. ___ There are mice in the kitchen.
6. ___ The garbage needs to be taken out.
7. ___ Let's look at carpets online.
8. ___ Make sure everything is washed, tidied, dusted, and put away.





Extension Activity

Find out about domestic cleaning services.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find out what types of cleaning services are available in your country.
- Find out where they are, what they do and how much they cost.
- Take notes and write your findings up in a paragraph.
- Bring your paragraph to class and read it to a partner.
- Listen to your partner's findings.
- Discuss what you have found, comparing the services.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I find out about domestic cleaning services.

☐ ☐

I write up a paragraph on my findings.

☐ ☐

I share and discuss my findings with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to vacuum** (verb): to clean with a vacuum cleaner
e.g. The carpets need vacuuming.
- **garbage** (noun): trash
e.g. The garbage needs to be taken out.
- **solution** (noun): the process of solving a problem
e.g. I am sure we can find a solution.
- **rate** (noun): tax or price
e.g. They have great rates.
- **to scrub** (verb): to clean hard with a brush
e.g. The kitchen and bathroom need a good scrub!
- **phenomenal** (adjective): wonderful or extraordinary
e.g. Thanks Sally, you're phenomenal!
- **to tidy** (verb): to clean
e.g. I can make sure everything is washed, tidied, dusted, and put away while you work.





Learning Points

Intonation of Short Questions, Statements and Question Tags

Intonation is the rise and fall of your voice when you speak. You use intonation to convey meaning. It is the speaker's choice.

In short statements, you use falling intonation to signal that you are finished what you are saying.

No, they aren't.

In short questions, the intonation patterns are:

Yes/No Question = Rising Intonation

Do you like cleaning the house?

WH/Information Question = Falling Intonation

What happened to you?

In **Tag Questions** (short questions at the end of statements) = Rising or Falling Intonation. You use **falling intonation** (your voice goes down) to signal that you believe what you said is correct. You use **rising intonation** (your voice goes up) when you are checking, because you are not sure if you are correct. These two sentences are the same, but they have slightly different meanings as they are said differently, depending on the speaker's intention.

You understand why I'm upset, don't you?

They're coming next week, aren't they?

Practice reading the dialogue out loud. Concentrate on the correct intonation of the questions as you read it.





Learning Points

Stressing **You** and **I**

You stress **you** and **I** to add meaning and emphasis to a statement.

When you stress a word, you make it longer, louder and a little higher tone. You can put stress on a word to emphasize it and make your meaning clearer.

You stress **you** or **I** when you want to emphasize something about a person that is not expected.

For example:

*I'm okay. What happened to **you**?*

- When you put stress on **you**, you shift the emphasis to the other person.

Read these sentences with stress on the bolded words.

- **I** call them all the time. **You** can too! **I** can call today if **you** can't. **I'm** not working today like **you** are.
- **You** stop worrying. **I'll** take care of it. **I'm** a great organizer!
- **I** get to help **you** out for a change!
- **You** are the best Sally! **I'll** leave it to **you**!

